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Protest Unites Victims Of Americanism

7,000 RALLY AT S.F. "PEOPLE'S BICENTENNIAL CELEBRATION"



Featured speakers at the huge San Francisco July 4th Coalition rally were (top row, left to right) JOHN TRUDELL, ERICKA HUGGINS, Mrs. MATTIE SHEPHERD, and ANDRES TORRES. Over 7,000 individuals representing 170 progressive organizations protested 200 years of oppression in America.

(San Francisco, Calif.) - For the 7,000 people who gathered in Delores Park here last Sunday, July 4, 1976, was certainly not a day to "honor" America's Bicentennial. Instead, the day marked the beginning of a new unity among the victims of Americanism, and those who joined the July 4th Coalition's memorable march and rally celebrated the coming together of this broad, multi-ethnic movement, while commemorating those whose sacrifice and struggle lay the foundation for the future victories.

Highlights of the Delores Park rally included speeches by: John Trudell of the American Indian Movement (AIM); Andres Torres from the Puerto Rican Socialist Party (PSP); Mrs. Mattie Shepherd, the mother of Tyrone Guyton; and Ericka Huggins, a leading member of the Black Panther Party. All the speeches, indeed, spoke to the need for positive social change, all stressing the three themes of the Coalition:

- "For Jobs and a Decent Standard of Living;
- "For Full Democracy and Equality;
- "For a Bicentennial Without Colonies — Freedom for all Oppressed Nations."

Garfield Park, where the march started, began filling up as early as 8:00 a.m., and by the time the first contingent, led by AIM and the PSP, set out on the 12-block walk through the city's predominantly Chicano Mission District at 10:00 a.m., literally thousands were on hand to participate.

The park and the street of the Mission District were alive with the brilliant colors of

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